Mark Pomi - Chief

KENTFIELD FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT

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1004 SIR FRANCIS DRAKE BOULEVARD

KENTFIELD CA. 94904

TO: Board of Directors

FROM: Mark Pomi, Fire Chief

SUBJECT: Ross Valley Paramedic Authority - November 3, 2026 Ballot Measure renewal proposal

DATE: 5/27/2026

Every four years, the citizens who reside within the member communities of the RVPA service area vote to fund the tax for a four-year period. The current tax expires on June 30, 2027. In order to maintain this revenue source, each JPA member agency must place the matter on a ballot. The purpose of the attached report is intended to fulfill the member agency's obligation to place this matter on the November 2026 ballot.

Please review and consider the attached Staff report and **Resolution 7-2026**.

Kentfield Fire Protection District
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SUBJECT

Consider approval of the Resolution Calling for an Election for the Passage of the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority Four-Year Special Parcel Tax for the Tax Cycle 2027-2031.

RECOMMENDATION

Staff recommends that the Board of Directors adopt the attached Resolution calling for an election for renewal of the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority ("RVPA") four-year special parcel tax for 2027-2031 and requesting the Marin County Board of Supervisors consolidate the election with the Statewide General Election.

BACKGROUND AND DISCUSSION

The Ross Valley Paramedic Authority has provided responsive, high-quality Fire Department paramedic and pre-hospital emergency medical care to the community for over 40 years. One of the oldest regional partnerships in Marin County, RVPA is a Joint Powers Authority formed in 1982 among the Cities/Towns of Corte Madera, Larkspur, Fairfax, Ross, and San Anselmo; the Kentfield Fire Protection District; the Sleepy Hollow Fire Protection District; and the County of Marin ("Member Agencies") to provide paramedic services in and across the Member Agencies' jurisdictions through a single public agency.

RVPA is funded primarily through special parcel tax revenues. Every four years the voters within each Member Agency's jurisdiction vote to fund the parcel tax for another four-year period. Voters have consistently approved the RVPA tax. The current tax expires on June 30, 2027. To maintain funding, each Member Agency must place the parcel tax on the ballot as a local ballot measure, which must be approved by two-thirds of the voters.

Under the proposed tax, each taxable residential unit is taxed at a rate of up to $107.50, and every 1000 square feet of developed nonresidential property, and is adjusted up to $4 per year. The current approved tax rate applies to residential units and every 1500 square feet for nonresidential uses through the end of fiscal year 2027. The proposed tax would apply to developed, nonresidential uses at every 1000 square feet. Additionally, the current adjustment rate would change from $3 to up to $4 per year.

During the period of the tax, the governing body of each Member Agency annually confirms the tax by adoption of a Resolution. RVPA recommends the annual increase in the tax within the limit every year based on the financial need of RVPA to maintain its service. The tax is not automatically increased $4 per year, but rather may be up to that amount depending on the financial condition of RVPA.

Below are the tax rates:

- FY 26-27 (current) $103.50
- FY 27-28 Up to: $107.50
- FY 28-29 Up to: $111.00
- FY 29-30 Up to: $114.50
- FY 30-31 Up to: $118.00

The proposed ballot language is as follows:

To maintain rapid 9-1-1 emergency response times and preserve the number of on-duty paramedics ready to respond to accidents/medical emergencies, shall the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority measure be adopted continuing for four years the paramedic services special tax of up to $107.50/ residential living unit or 1,000 square feet of developed nonresidential property, adjusted up to $4/ year, generating approximately $326,000 annually, with annual audits, public spending disclosure and all funds for local paramedic services?

RECOMMENDATION

Staff recommends that the Board of Directors adopt the attached Resolution calling for an election for passage of the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority ("RVPA") four-year special parcel tax for 2027-2031 and requesting the Marin County Board of Supervisors consolidate the election with the Statewide General Election.

BALLOT ARGUMENT

A Yes Vote Will:

- Ensure the existing high-level paramedic emergency medical response services
- Continue local control over these tax revenues
- Maintain rapid emergency medical response

Your tax pays for a significant portion of the paramedic program. Additional funds are collected from insurance companies through third party billing and from billing of nonresident customers. In addition, your tax covers continuing paramedic training, the cost of supplies and equipment and the replacement of ambulance units when needed.

Our goal is to continue to provide state-of-the-art paramedic care in the Ross Valley.
We need your vote to continue this vital service.

ATTACHMENT

1. **Resolution 7-2026**

Mark Pomi
Fire Chief

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Kentfield Fire Protection District

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RESOLUTION NO. 7-2026

A RESOLUTION OF THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS OF THE KENTFIELD FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT CALLING FOR AN ELECTION TO BE HELD IN ITS JURISDICTION ON NOVEMBER 3, 2026 FOR THE PURPOSE OF SUBMITTING TO THE VOTERS A MEASURE AUTHORIZING THE CONTINUATION OF A SPECIAL PARCEL TAX FOR PARAMEDIC SERVICES AND REQUESTING THE MARIN COUNTY BOARD OF SUPERVISORS TO CONSOLIDATE SAID ELECTION WITH THE GENERAL ELECTION CONDUCTED ON THAT DATE

WHEREAS, the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority ("RVPA") is an eight member California Joint Powers Authority formed by agreement in 1982 pursuant to the California Joint Exercise of Powers Act, Gov. Code, §§ 6500 *et seq.*, by and among the Cities/Towns of Corte Madera, Larkspur, Fairfax, Ross, and San Anselmo; the Kentfield Fire Protection District; the Sleepy Hollow Fire Protection District; and the County of Marin ("Member Agencies") for the purpose of providing paramedic and pre-hospital emergency medical services throughout and across the Member Agencies' jurisdictional boundaries by a single, consolidated agency; and

WHEREAS, the Kentfield Fire Protection District has been a Member Agency of RVPA since its inception over 40 years ago; and

WHEREAS, the community has consistently received responsive, high-quality paramedic and pre-hospital emergency medical care from RVPA and the Kentfield Fire Protection District wishes to maintain and ensure this service into the future; and

WHEREAS, RVPA is funded largely with tax revenues from its Member Agencies; and

WHEREAS, a statewide election will be held on November 3, 2026 ("General Election"); and

WHEREAS, California Government Code section 53722 allows the Kentfield Fire Protection District to submit to the voters a proposition for the imposition of a special tax to be approved by a two-thirds vote of the voters voting in an election on the issue; and

WHEREAS, the voters of the Kentfield Fire Protection District have consistently voted in favor of the RVPA special tax for paramedic services and last approved such a tax in 2022; and

WHEREAS, the monies from the RVPA special tax are used exclusively for paramedic and pre-hospital emergency care services; and

WHEREAS, through the adoption of this Resolution, the Board of Directors of the Kentfield Fire Protection District desires to propose to its voters the renewal of an additional four years of the special tax in the amounts specified in the Resolution at the November 3, 2026 election; and

WHEREAS, pursuant to California Elections Code sections 10403 *et seq.*, the Kentfield Fire Protection District Board of Directors may request consolidation of the election with any and all other elections to be held on November 3, 2026, and may request that the Marin County Registrar of Voters perform certain election services; and

WHEREAS, the Kentfield Fire Protection District desires that the election on the special tax measure be consolidated with the statewide General Election to be held on November 3, 2026; and

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED as follows:

SECTION 1. RECITALS. The above recitals are true and correct and incorporated as findings herein.

SECTION 2. ELECTION CALLED. There is hereby called and ordered to be held in the Kentfield Fire Protection District of California on Tuesday, November 3, 2026.

SECTION 3. BALLOT QUESTION. The special parcel tax measure shall be submitted to the voters on the ballot in the form of the following question:

To maintain rapid 9-1-1 emergency response times and preserve the number of on-duty paramedics ready to respond to accidents/medical emergencies, shall the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority measure be adopted continuing for four years the paramedic services special tax of up to $107.50/residential living unit or 1,000 square feet of developed nonresidential property, adjusted up to $4/year, generating approximately $326,000 annually, with annual audits, public spending disclosure and all funds for local paramedic services?

SECTION 4. REQUESTING CONSOLIDATION OF ELECTIONS. Pursuant to Elections Code section 10403, the Board of Supervisors of the County of Marin is hereby requested to consolidate with the said election on Tuesday, November 3, 2026 and with the statewide General Election to be held on the same date, and provide all necessary services for this election.

SECTION 5. NOTICE TO COUNTY OF MARIN. The Fire Chief is hereby authorized and directed to file a certified copy of this Resolution with the Marin County Board of Supervisors and the Registrar of the County of Marin, pursuant to Elections Code section 10403.

SECTION 6. REBUTTALS. That rebuttals shall be received to ballot arguments made by this Board of Directors on behalf of said measure.

SECTION 7. EXECUTION. The Fire Chief is hereby authorized and directed to do any and all things necessary to execute and deliver any and all documents necessary or advisable in order to complete the process for placing the measure on the November 3, 2026 ballot.

SECTION 8. SEVERABILITY. If any section, subsection, sentence, clause, phrase, or portion of this Resolution is for any reason held to be invalid or unconstitutional by the decision of any court, such decision shall not affect the validity of the remaining portions of this Resolution. The board hereby declares that it would have adopted this Resolution and each section, subsection, sentence, clause, and phrase irrespective of the fact that any one or more of same be declared invalid and unconstitutional.

PASSED AND ADOPTED at a regular meeting of the Board of Directors of the Kentfield Fire Protection District on the 10th day of June 2026 by the following vote:

AYES:

NOES:

ABSENT:

ABSTAIN:

_____

Ronald Naso, Chairman, Board of Directors

ATTEST:

_____

Barry Evergettis, Secretary, Board of Directors